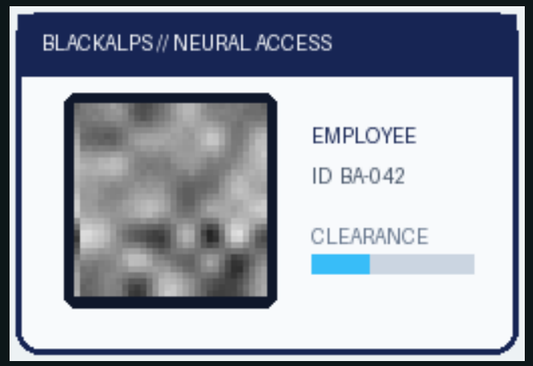
THE CHALLENGE · AN IMAGE DECIDES ACCESS

To get in as admin, convince the model.

SUPPLIED BADGE



Classified as “EMPLOYEE”.

THE SCANNER RETURNS SCORES

EMPLOYEE	
INVALID	
ADMIN	≥ 99.5%

The threshold to exceed for access.

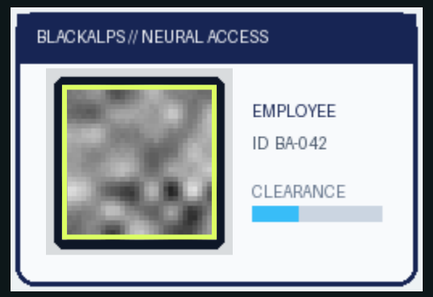
THE TAKEAWAY

We can change the image and observe **the score returned on each attempt.**

THE CLUE · PREPROCESSING IS PROVIDED, THE MODEL STAYS HIDDEN

The model sees just one square. We control every cell.

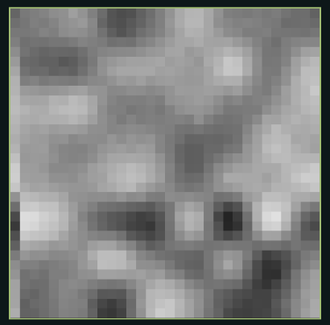
SUPPLIED IMAGE · 256 × 176



The scanner crops the outlined area.

→

SQUARE · 96 × 96



Grayscale, then average each 3 × 3 block.

→

MODEL INPUT · 32 × 32



A block of nine identical pixels sets the value of one cell.

THE TAKEAWAY

Only the cropped square needs changing: **the model never sees the rest of the badge.**

THE BREAKTHROUGH · USE THE MODEL'S FEEDBACK

Test variations in pairs.
Follow the stronger signal.

STARTING POINT The employee badge. Random images were mostly classified as “INVALID”.

01

Vary in both directions

```
badge + variation
badge − variation
```

20 directions tested in pairs:
40 images in one batch.

→

02

Compare the feedback

LESS ADMIN | MORE ADMIN

Score differences
reveal useful directions.

→

03

Update the badge



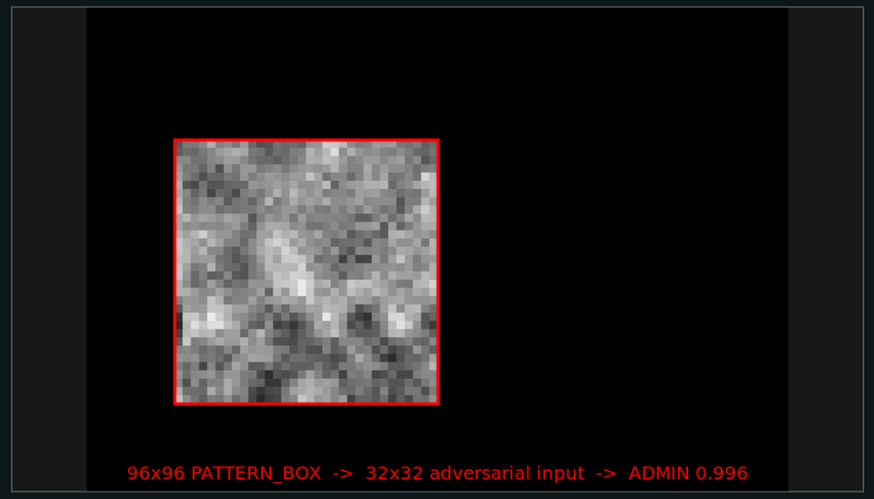
Combine those directions,
take a step, then repeat.

THE TAKEAWAY

The agent learns **how to change the image** by observing the model's response.

THE RESULT · THE MODEL GRANTS ACCESS

The badge looked like noise.
The model saw the boss.



SAVED EVIDENCE · CLICK TO ENLARGE

ADMIN SCORE REPORTED IN THE JOURNAL

99.6%

Required threshold: 99.5%.

ACCESS GRANTED

`BA26{r3ached_1h3_t0P}`

THE TAKEAWAY

An image-based access decision can be **steered using the exposed scores.**